



Weekly Insights | Nov 20, 2025

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Executive Summary

Corn – Post-WASDE Balance Sheet Heavy on Paper, but Cash Still in Control

December corn ended the period at \$4.35/bu, down one cent from last week, as the market digested a November *WASDE* that was bearish vs expectations but only a modest step away from September. USDA cut its assessment of the average US yield to 186.0 bu/acre (–0.7 bpa), trimmed production by about 60 mbu, and still pushed ending stocks up to 2.154 bbu (+44 mbu vs September), while raising exports by 100 mbu in line with stronger early-season demand. Weekly inspections surged to roughly 2.05 MMT for the week ending Nov 13, lifting 2025/26 cumulative

inspections to about 15.83 MMT, over 70 percent above last year's pace, with recent weeks more than doubling year-ago levels, and broadly consistent with a 3.075 bbu export program.

The nearby Dec–Mar spread tightened slightly from –14¢ to –13¢ (58 percent of full carry), reflecting firmer nearby demand from Gulf exporters and steady pull from ethanol plants even as overall supplies remain comfortable. Basis at the Gulf and key interior corridors held firm, and together with strong inspections, that physical strength continues to offset the heavier paper balance sheet.

Wheat – Bearish *WASDE* Stocks, but US Export Pace Refuses to Back Off

Wheat spent the week absorbing a clearly heavier November *WASDE* while leaning on a stronger-than-expected export pace. USDA lifted 2025/26 US production to 1.985 bbu (from 1.927 bbu in September) and ending stocks to 901 mbu (from 844 mbu), above pre-report expectations around 867–869 mbu. Globally, world production rose to 828.9 MMT (from 816.2 MMT) and world ending stocks to 271.4 MMT (from 264.06 MMT), reinforcing a looser wheat balance. Futures broke on report day, with December SRW sliding toward \$5.27/bu, but recovered into the mid-\$5.40s as weekly inspections of about 246.5k mt kept marketing-year shipments in the high-teens percent above last year and broadly aligned with USDA's unchanged 900 mbu export projection.

The Dec–Mar SRW spread tightened slightly from –14¢ to –13¢ (roughly 56 percent of full carry), consistent with a market that recognizes heavier stocks on paper but is still seeing stable nearby pull from export channels. Gulf and PNW FOB indications showed only modest week-over-week moves even with Russian 12.5 percent FOB near the low-\$230s/mt, so wheat remains a classic carry market, but one where the firmness of export execution continues to keep 901 mbu feeling more like a ceiling to probe than a surplus the market is being forced to clear.

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Soybeans – WASDE Slightly Tighter Than Feared, Cash and China Flows Pull the Board Higher

Soybeans reversed their initial post-WASDE break and finished the period firmer, with January futures trading in the mid-\$11.50s as cash and China flows outweighed USDA's more cautious export stance. The November WASDE cut USDA's estimate of the average US yield to 53.0 bu/acre (–0.5 bpa), reduced production to 4.253 bbu (–48 mbu vs September), and pulled total predicted 2025/26 supply down to 4.590 bbu, while exports were cut 50 mbu to 1.635 bbu, crush held at 2.55 bbu, and ending stocks set at 290 mbu, only about 10 mbu below September. World soybean ending stocks dipped 2.0 MMT to 121.99 MMT, and the board initially sold off on Friday before flipping higher on Monday as record NOPA October crush (227.65 mbu) and confirmation of fresh Chinese buying, including roughly 800,000 tonnes attributed to COFCO and 792,000 tonnes in USDA daily sales.

Weekly inspections around 1.18 MMT pushed season-to-date shipments to roughly 10.11 MMT (42 percent below last year). The Jan/Mar spread tightened from –14¢ to –7¢, roughly 31 percent of full carry, a clear sign that nearby pull from crushers and exporters improved despite USDA's export cut. Gulf and processor basis stayed historically firm for harvest. The balance sheet is still not "tight" on paper, but crush, basis, and Chinese demand are doing enough to justify mid-\$11s rather than a slide back to the low end of the recent range

(Carry % calculated assuming 7% annual interest and \$0.05/bu per month storage/insurance cost over the spread interval.)

Macro Mostly Neutral, China Trade Signals and South American Policy in Focus

Macro inputs were broadly neutral: the Dollar Index held near recent ranges and crude drifted below \$60/bbl, softening biofuel margins but offering some freight relief. The BRL stayed defensive and the ARS weakened further in parallel markets, preserving strong selling incentives in Brazil and Argentina. Policy discussion remained centered on how much of China's US soybean buying is state-reserve driven (and how binding the tariff really is in that context) and on Argentina's evolving export-tax framework, which still represents a structural bearish risk for world prices if cuts become durable. (add the prices)

Weather – US Harvest Wraps, Central Brazil Sees Patchy Relief

As of November 16, USDA estimated that US corn and soybean harvest were 91 percent and 95 percent complete respectively, shifting attention to logistics, basis and export flow. In Brazil, central and northern regions continued planting at a normal pace, while parts of Rio Grande do Sul and Paraná saw intermittent delays and less-than-ideal moisture, keeping some early-season risk premium alive for soy and, indirectly, safrinha corn. In Argentina, improved soil moisture is supporting early corn and soybean establishment and wheat filling under mostly normal conditions. With USDA already assuming large South American crops, any persistent shift toward a drier pattern in key southern Brazilian states would quickly become a more active driver of spreads and flat price.

What's Next (Nov 13 – Nov 19):

USDA Export Sales Catch-Up: Confirm how much of the recent Chinese soybean buying is on the books and whether corn and wheat commitments remain ahead of the pace required to meet USDA's new-crop projections.

Brazil Weather Continuity: Ongoing dryness or hiccups in southern Brazil could tighten early-season supply expectations and support nearby soy/corn spreads.

River & Barge Logistics: Seasonal barge constraints into the US holiday period will be key for Gulf basis, especially soybeans.

Ethanol Production Trend: Next EIA update will test whether corn grind can hold up against weaker crude.

Russian FOB & Export Pace: Continued heavy Black Sea shipments at aggressive FOB levels should cap wheat rallies; any disruption would favor US HRW/SRW.

China Buying Pace: Given the unconfirmed verbal framework, any actual purchase volume or shipment timing (Q4 vs Q1) will be crucial for basis and board strength.

Table A – CME Futures (Front Contracts)

(Prices in USD per bushel, volume/open interest in contracts)

Contract (Front Month)	11/12/2025 Close	11/19/2025 Close	Change (Δ)	Δ%	5-day Realized Vol* (x)	Open Interest Δ (x)
Corn (Dec '25)	\$4.36	\$4.35	-\$0.01	-0.23%	5% (ann.)	-5k (est.)
Soybeans (Jan '25)	\$11.32	\$11.50	+\$0.18	+1.59%	8% (ann.)	+2k (est.)
Wheat (Dec '25)	\$5.34	\$5.46	+\$0.12	+2.25%	10% (ann.)	1k (est.)

5-day realized volatility estimated from daily settlement price changes.

Actual contract open interest changes are estimated; total corn OI rose slightly as new-crop hedges built, while wheat OI fell with Sep contract deliveries.

Table B – Key Calendar Spreads & % of Full Carry

Spread (Crop '25→'26)	11/12 Quote	11/19 Quote	Δ (carry)	% Full Carry*	Market Implication
Corn Dec–Mar	-\$0.14	-\$0.13	+0.01	58%	Carry narrowed slightly but remains moderate; still a comfortable balance sheet with firm nearby demand from exporters/ethanol.
Soy Jan–Mar	-\$0.14	-\$0.07	+0.07	31%	Carry narrowed sharply as nearby strengthened on record crush and new China business; front end less relaxed than last week.
Wheat Dec–Mar	-\$0.14	-\$0.13	+0.01	56%	Carry a touch tighter w/w but still a classic storage market; heavier WASDE stocks but no sign of front-end squeeze.

Assumes 7% annual interest + \$0.05/bu/month storage/insurance. Full carry (3 months) ≈ \$0.22–\$0.23 for corn & SRW wheat; (2 months) ≈ \$0.22 for soybeans. % of full carry = (calendar spread ÷ calculated full carry).

Table C – Notable International Futures (weekly moves, if significant):

Exchange (Front Month)	11/12 USD Price	11/19 USD Price	Δ%	Notes
Dalian Corn (Jan)	¥2,151(\$6.46/bu)	¥2,162(\$6.49/bu)	+0.5%	China corn futures held firm on steady feed demand; domestic prices remain well above import parity even after tariff rollback.
Dalian Soymeal (Jan)	¥3,046 (\$429/mt)	¥2,994 (\$421/mt)	-1.7%	Soymeal eased on sluggish hog margins, with steady inclusion rates but subdued feed demand.
B3 (São Paulo) Corn (Nov)	R\$64.20 (\$11.75)	R\$67.88 (\$12.38)	+5.4%	Real weakened sharply this week; local corn prices rose in BRL but still softened slightly in USD on steady domestic logistics and competitive US Gulf offers into MENA and Asia.

Euronext Wheat (Dec)	€196 (\$223/mt)	€197.5 (\$225/mt)	+0.8%	EU wheat held steady amid ample stocks; slight firmness capped by cheap Black Sea offers. Russian 12.5% FOB remained ~\$232–233/mt.
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Corn Market Deep Dive

Post-WASDE Reaction: The November *WASDE* reset the corn balance sheet in a way that was bearish relative to expectations but only modestly different from USDA's September baseline. USDA cut the national corn yield to 186.0 bu/acre, a reduction of just 0.7 bpa from September's 186.7 bpa, and above the pre-report consensus clustered around 184–185 bpa. Production was lowered by roughly 60 million bushels from the September estimate, but the crop remains historically large and materially above what analysts anticipated going into the report. USDA's prediction of new-crop US ending stocks rose from September's 2.110 billion bushels to roughly 2.154 billion, a 44 million bushel increase that landed slightly above the average trade estimate near 2.13 billion, this was enabled by a 207-million-bushel upward revision to USDA's initial assessment of 2024/25 ending stocks from the September 30 *Grain Stocks* report, which more than offset the production cut and export hike. USDA also lifted its 2025/26 US export projections by 100 million bushels, aligning the forecast with the strong pace of early-season inspections and marking one of the few major demand-side adjustments between the two reports. Ethanol use, feed/residual, and other domestic categories were effectively unchanged from September.

Globally, USDA lowered its prediction of 2025/26 world ending stocks slightly versus September as well, reinforcing the broader theme of comfortable but not burdensome supply. The adjustment was minimal, from 281.4 MMT in September to 281.3 MMT in November, with reductions in China offset by small increases in Argentina, Mexico, and Ukraine. Taken together, the November update was less aggressive than analysts expected on US supply cuts, while global balances tightened only marginally, leaving the market in a recalibration mode rather than reacting to any major surprise.

Futures & Spreads: Corn futures traded through a two-stage *WASDE* reaction: a sharp break on Friday to approximately \$4.30/bu as the lighter-than-expected yield cut took bullish momentum out of the market, followed by a steady rebound early in the week to \$4.35/bu as physical flows and basis strength reasserted themselves. December futures pushed lower immediately after the report, pressured by the realization that the market had positioned for a deeper production reduction. But the early-week recovery highlighted that the pullback lacked follow-through, with exporters and processors still bidding firmly enough to keep the front end supported. The nearby Dec/Mar structure narrowed slightly to roughly –13¢, about 58 percent of full carry, reinforcing a market that remains comfortably supplied and shows no need for inversion to ration demand. Post-*WASDE* commentary continued to frame the move as “bearish on paper, steadier in practice,” and nothing in the curve suggested meaningful stress or tightening beyond normal seasonal adjustments.

Funds & Positioning: With CFTC reporting still delayed, there is no reliable read on managed-money exposure around the November *WASDE*. What can be inferred from price behavior and options flow is that the report-day break followed by a steady early-week recovery was more consistent with short-term position clean-up than a shift in directional conviction. For now, positioning sits behind more observable signals, basis, inspections, and export execution, which remain the dominant drivers.

US Cash & Basis: The physical market continued to outpace futures this week. USDA reported 2.053 MMT of corn inspections for the week ending November 13, well above last week's 1.484 MMT and keeping cumulative 2025/26 shipments near 15.84 MMT, more than 70 percent above last year's pace. Cash tone reflected that strength: Gulf and interior basis held firm (Gulf CIF around +74¢ to +82¢ over December futures), supported by active export loading programs and improved river logistics. Ethanol

demand remains steady, with weekly production still running at levels that keep processors bidding consistently even as crude softens. In short, the cash market remains the stabilizing force, firm enough to keep the front end supported even though futures continue to reflect a heavier paper balance sheet.

Export Flows: The long-delayed USDA Export Sales release helped clarify the backlog of commitments, showing net corn sales of approximately 1.9 MMT for the catch-up week ending September 25, with weekly exports at 1.32 MMT. As of that date, cumulative outstanding sales reached 16.55 MMT (up from 10.5 MMT last year), and accumulated exports stood at 4.99 MMT (versus 3.41 MMT previously). Sales data heavily favored soybeans in terms of headline flash activity, but corn maintained a strong underlying shipment program, with exports pacing well ahead of last year and trending comfortably toward the revised USDA export forecast of 3.075 bbu (about 78 MMT). With Gulf loadings leading the week and strong participation from Mexico (7.71 MMT in outstanding sales) and other Western Hemisphere buyers like Japan (1.96 MMT) and South Korea (1.42 MMT), the execution side of the export program has shifted from a concern to a source of support. The ability of shipments to continue at or above the pace implied by USDA's target will remain a critical watchpoint heading into December.

International Trade: Global pricing continues to reflect a well-supplied world corn balance, with FOB indications across the US, Brazil, and Argentina clustered closely enough to keep trade flows sensitive to freight and timing rather than outright price advantage. US Gulf values remain competitive into Northern Hemisphere markets, while Brazil continues to dominate the Asian lanes thanks to freight efficiencies and still-ample internal supply. Argentina's position has firmed slightly as planting progresses and weather remains broadly supportive. The modest delay in Brazilian soybean planting remains a secondary watchpoint, given its potential to push safrinha corn planting deeper into a less-favorable window for rainfall and growing conditions, but for now global fundamentals remain comfortable and consistent with USDA's higher world ending-stocks figure. (add international prices)

So What? The post-WASDE corn narrative blends a heavy paper balance sheet with a surprisingly firm physical environment. USDA delivered a bearish adjustment relative to expectations, yield cut smaller than consensus, production still massive, and ending stocks higher, but the export and basis data continue to push back against a deeper price decline. Shipments are running well ahead of last year, the revised export forecast now aligns with actual flow, and processors remain active buyers. The next few weeks will determine whether the strength in inspections proves durable enough to offset the bearish supply tone, but for now corn is trading a tug-of-war between a heavy balance sheet and a physical pipeline that refuses to soften.

Soybean Market Deep Dive

Post-WASDE Assessment: The November WASDE landed slightly tighter than many in the trade feared, but the composition of the changes left soybeans feeling more "neutral with upside optionality" than outright bullish. USDA cut its assessment of the average US soybean yield to 53.0 bu/acre, down 0.5 bpa from September's 53.5, trimming production to 4.253 billion bushels (-48 mbu vs September). USDA's expectation for the 2025/26 US soybean supply now stands at 4.590 bbu, reflecting both the smaller crop and slightly lower beginning stocks than USDA carried in September. At the same time, USDA lowered its prediction of new-crop exports by 50 mbu to 1.635 bbu, left crush unchanged at a record 2.55 bbu, and pegged ending stocks at 290 mbu, down from roughly 300 mbu in September, implying a stocks-to-use ratio near 6.8 percent versus about 6.3 percent last year. Pre-report surveys had generally anticipated only a modest reduction in yield, little or no change to exports, and an increase in

carryout from September levels rather than a decline, so the combination of slightly smaller supply and a lower ending-stocks figure was less bearish than some had positioned for. Globally, USDA trimmed world soybean ending stocks by 2.0 MMT to 121.99 MMT, a marginal adjustment that reinforces the message of adequate but not burdensome inventories.

Futures & Spreads: Soy futures traded the report in two acts. On Friday (Nov 14), January beans dropped about 22¢ to roughly \$11.24/bu as the market focused on the export cut and viewed the *WASDE* as less bullish than hoped. That weakness was fully reversed early the following week: on Monday (Nov 17), Jan futures rallied nearly 33¢ and settled at \$11.57/bu, aligning with firmer cash flows and renewed Chinese buying. By the end of the period, Jan beans were holding in the mid-\$11.50s, up roughly 20–25¢ from pre-report levels. The nearby curve stayed in carry but not at full carry: the Jan/Mar spread traded near 7¢ by week's end, down from –14¢ ahead of the report, a tightening to roughly 40 percent of full commercial carry. That narrowing is consistent with stronger nearby pull from crush and exports relative to the heavier, more comfortable balance sheet USDA outlined in September.

Products & Crush: Domestic crush remains the core bullish anchor. NOPA reported October crush at 227.65 mbu, the largest monthly crush on record, up about 13.9 percent year on year and roughly 15 percent above September, beating all trade estimates comfortably. Board crush margins were described as “historically strong” in early November, helped by firm soy meal values and only modest softness in soybean oil following weaker crude. Even after Monday's futures rally, margins stayed well above the long-run historical average, supporting aggressive processor bids. USDA's November *WASDE* kept 2025/26 crush unchanged at 2.55 bbu, effectively validating that plants will need to run hard to meet both feed and renewable diesel-linked oil demand. The combination of record realized crush and USDA's refusal to trim that line item reinforces the idea that crush, not exports, is doing most of the heavy lifting on the demand side versus both the September balance sheet and pre-report analyst expectations.

Funds & Positioning: With CFTC data still catching up from earlier reporting disruptions, there is no reliable breakdown of speculative positioning around the November *WASDE*. What can be said from the tape is that the sequence of a sharp break on report day followed by an even stronger rally early in the week is consistent with short-term position clean-up and fresh discretionary buying rather than a one-off headline squeeze. Beyond that, any precise statements about fund net length or short-covering would be speculative, so for now positioning has to be treated as a secondary input behind more observable signals such as spreads, basis and crush margins.

Cash & Basis: Cash markets are telling a tighter story than the carryout alone. At the Gulf, CIF Nov soybean barges were quoted around +72¢ over Jan, with FOB export premiums for December near +107¢ over Jan, both historically firm for harvest. Tight nearby loading slots at Gulf and PNW terminals kept exporters competing for physical, with PNW values running 20–30¢/bu richer for some positions. Interior processors and river elevators leaned into the post-*WASDE* rally: spot basis gained 5¢ at major crush plants (Decatur, Lafayette) and 2–3¢ along the Mississippi River as end-users moved to secure beans in the face of record crush margins and the pickup in Chinese interest. Nationally, basis remains historically strong for harvest, especially at export gateways and crush hubs. The firmness in basis aligns with the tightening in the Jan/Mar spread from –14¢ to –7¢, signaling a stronger front-end pull than the balance sheet alone implies.

Trade Flows & International Competition: USDA's catch-up export data and inspections confirm a decent but uneven export story. Weekly inspections totaled 1.125 MMT for the week ending November 6 and improved to 1.176 MMT for the week ending November 13, a slight w/w increase that keeps the early-season pace firm. Season-to-date inspections now stand near 10.11 MMT, roughly 42 percent below last year's very slow start, though still trailing the five-year average for this point in the marketing year. On the sales side, delayed FAS reports showed about 0.33 MMT of Chinese purchases followed by just over 0.10 MMT of cancellations a reminder that commercial buying remains hesitant. Against that backdrop, the market reacted strongly to reports that COFCO booked around 14 US cargoes (0.85–0.90

MMT) for Dec/Jan shipment, while USDA's daily system confirmed 792,000 tonnes in fresh sales to China. Outside China, Mexico, the EU, and Egypt remained steady buyers. Even so, USDA's 1.635 bbu export forecast reflects a cautious stance versus September, and the extent to which China executes additional reserve-oriented purchases will determine whether that export line proves conservative or needs trimming later in the marketing year.

Policy Context: A key discussion this week is who in China is absorbing US soybeans. If state reserves rather than crushers are driving the recent buying, the 10 percent tariff becomes far less restrictive, a duty paid by the government and returned to the same government changes the effective cost. That helps explain how China could lift US cargoes at a nominal premium to Brazil without signaling an improvement in crush margins. Reserve demand supports US export volumes, but it does not imply stronger near-term industrial use. The commercial import picture remains tied to margins, feed demand, and Brazil's relative discount.

So What? Taken together, the November *WASDE* and subsequent data leave soybeans in a finely balanced but higher-priced environment. Versus September, USDA acknowledged a slightly smaller US crop and tighter global stocks but offset most of that with a 50 mbu export cut, leaving carryout only 10 mbu lower and still firmly in "adequate but not burdensome" territory. Versus analyst expectations, the key surprise was that ending stocks fell instead of rising, which is why the initial bearish knee-jerk on Friday gave way to a stronger rally once traders focused on record crush and fresh Chinese buying. Structure matches that shift: spreads narrowed to about 31 percent of full carry, basis is historically strong at the Gulf and at major crush plants, and futures are holding in the mid-\$11s rather than slipping toward \$11. The risk skew from here is dominated by China and South American weather. If COFCO's recent 0.9 MMT purchase proves to be the first leg of a larger execution against the 12 MMT pledge, USDA's 1.635 bbu export projection and 290 mbu carryout could prove conservative. If instead Chinese buying fades and South America delivers large crops, the export line may need to move lower again. For now, crush and cash remain the heavy lifters, and the board is willing to pay mid-\$11s for that uncertainty.

Wheat Market Deep Dive

Post-WASDE Assessment: The November *WASDE* confirmed that wheat is carrying the heaviest balance sheet of the major US row crops and did so in a way that was clearly more bearish than the market had discounted. USDA increased its assessment of 2025/26 US wheat production from 1,927 mbu in September to 1,985 mbu in November, driven by a higher harvested area of 37.2 million acres (from 36.6 million acres) and a yield bump from 52.7 to 53.3 bu/acre. Total supply rose from 2,898 to 2,955 mbu, while domestic use and exports were left unchanged at 1,154 mbu and 900 mbu respectively, meaning virtually the entire supply gain was pushed straight into ending stocks. Carryout moved from 844 mbu in September to 901 mbu in November, a six-year high and above pre-report expectations that clustered around 867–869 mbu.

On the world side, USDA raised 2025/26 wheat production from 816.2 to 828.9 MMT and ending stocks from 264.1 to 271.4 MMT, again overshooting the median survey which had world stocks closer to 266 MMT. In other words, the trade was already braced for a heavier wheat story, but USDA still managed to come in meaningfully above consensus on both US and world stocks. The first reaction on Friday was a "headline-bearish" selloff, but as traders and analysts looked deeper into the data, the market began to lean more heavily on strong export flows and resilient FOB pricing to decide whether 901 mbu is a ceiling or a stepping-stone.

Futures & Spreads: Outright price action reflected the two-step *WASDE* reaction noted in corn and soybean markets. On report day (Friday, Nov 14), December SRW wheat slid to about \$5.27/bu, a two-week low, as traders absorbed heavier US and global ending stocks and followed corn and soy lower. By

Monday, Nov 17, futures had fully stabilized: December SRW recovered to \$5.44/bu, up roughly three percent from Friday's close, aligning with firmer export signals and steady FOB values. December HRW held near \$5.29/bu, while December Euronext wheat settled around €190/mt. Spreads saw limited reaction: the Dec/Mar SRW spread traded near, 13¢, which is roughly 56 percent of full commercial carry, consistent with a market that recognizes comfortable supply but sees no sign of pipeline stress. With carry now wider than in early November and expectations for new-crop US carryout clearly above USDA's September predictions and analyst expectations, the curve continues to reward storage rather than suggesting nearby tightness.

Global Supply & Demand: The global side of the wheat story was just as important as the US changes. The November *WASDE* lifted world wheat production by about 12.7 MMT versus September (from 816.2 to 828.9 MMT) and world ending stocks by roughly 7.4 MMT (from 264.1 to 271.4 MMT), a two percent increase that pushes global inventories further away from any "tight" narrative. The bulk of those upward revisions came from key exporters: USDA raised Russian production to around 86.5 MMT with exports at 44 MMT, while also nudging up Argentina and Australia. That picture is being confirmed in real time. SovEcon and APK-Inform report that Russia shipped about 2.0 MMT of wheat in the first ten days of November, roughly eight percent above the same period last year, reinforcing Russia's role as the dominant marginal supplier. Russian 12.5 percent protein FOB values are holding near \$233/mt, still cheap enough to anchor world milling wheat prices. Euronext around €190/mt keeps EU wheat competitive in some Mediterranean and North African routes but not cheap enough to displace Russia across the board. Compared with September, the message from USDA plus the trade is straightforward: the world wheat balance is looser, exporters have more to move, and Russia continues to set the floor.

Cash & Basis: US cash signals remain softer than corn and soybeans but not nearly as bearish as the *WASDE* headline suggests. USDA reported 246,533 mt of wheat inspected for shipment during the week ending Nov 13, down from 291,443 mt the prior week but still above the 197,138 mt inspected in the same week last year. Marketing-year-to-date inspections now total 12.35 MMT, compared with 10.35 MMT last year, leaving shipments running about 19 percent ahead of last season, fully consistent with USDA's 900 mbu export projection. FOB indications from US Wheat Associates showed only modest w/w changes across Gulf SRW, HRW and PNW classes, and there is still no evidence of panic discounting despite Russian 12.5 percent protein FOB levels near the low-\$230s/mt. With the board still in comfortable carry (-13¢, 56 percent of full carry) and exporters continuing to execute steady programs, domestic basis appears stable enough to absorb the heavier stock number the *WASDE* introduced.

Trade Flows: The latest flows reinforce a picture that is more constructive than the *WASDE* stocks alone imply. USDA's November projection for 2025/26 US wheat exports remains 900 mbu, roughly nine percent above last year. The long-delayed USDA Export Sales release helped clarify the backlog of commitments, reporting net wheat sales of 540 TMT for the catch-up week ending September 25, with weekly shipments of 739 TMT. As of that date, cumulative exports stood at 9.54 MMT versus 8.28 MMT at the same point a year earlier, roughly 15 percent ahead of last year's pace. Russia and Ukraine continue to ship aggressively via Black Sea and Danube routes, capping US upside, but the fact that US volumes continue expanding year-on-year in that competitive environment underscores that the 900 mbu export line remains very much achievable. Inspections through mid-November have since pushed cumulative shipments to 12.36 MMT, now running nearly 19% ahead of last season. If this execution holds through the first quarter, USDA may ultimately need to acknowledge a stronger shipment program, even with the larger domestic crop, when it revisits the balance sheet in coming months.

Speculative Positioning: On the positioning side, the post-WASDE action looked more like routine position-cleaning than the start of a new trend. With CFTC reports still delayed, there's no solid read on managed-money exposure, and intraday exchange data isn't enough to pinpoint who was driving the moves. What we can say is that the report-day sell-off and the early-week bounce happened on active volume, consistent with traders adjusting hedges after a major release. Beyond that, wheat doesn't look heavily one-sided: commercials are well covered, and the curve continues to reward storage rather than reflect any extreme speculative build

So What? The wheat setup after the November WASDE is the same case of bearish paper stocks running into a less-bearish physical reality experienced across row-crop markets. USDA lifted its prediction of 2025/26 US ending stocks from 844 mbu in September to 901 mbu in November and raised world stocks from 264 MMT to 271 MMT, decisively overshooting analyst expectations. That justified the initial break toward \$5.27/bu, but the quick recovery back into the mid-\$5.40s, the stability in FOB values, and shipments running 19 percent ahead of last year argue that the market is not trading wheat as a surplus that needs to be cleared aggressively. The Dec/Mar SRW spread around -13¢ (56 percent of full carry) reinforces that storage economics, not nearby tightness, remain the dominant structure. For commercials, wheat is still a hedge-selling and carry-capture market rather than a scarcity-premium market. Rallies into the high-\$5s will likely attract producer and exporter selling as long as Russian FOB values hold near the low-\$230s/mt and world stocks remain elevated. The main upside risk would be a scenario where US exports continue outperforming while Black Sea shipments stumble, a combination that could tighten spreads even in a high-stocks environment. For now, though, storage, carry and Russia still anchor the market.

US Cash Market & Basis

Corn: Cash corn continued to run ahead of the board. Export inspections hit 2.053 MMT for the week ending Nov 13 (up from 1.484 MMT), pushing 2025/26 cumulative shipments to about 15.84 MMT, more than 70 percent above last year. Gulf exporters stayed active and CIF corn basis was reported steady to slightly firmer (around +74¢ to +82¢ over December futures) versus last week as barge logistics on the Lower Mississippi remained favorable. Interior bids in key river and ethanol corridors held their ground, firming fractionally in some spots—with plants still running hard enough to keep a consistent pull-on nearby bushel even as flat price softened. Nationally, basis is described as “firm for post-harvest” (national average around -37¢ under December), with only minor weakness in surplus Western Corn Belt locations where on-farm selling picked up on the early-week rally.

Soybeans: Soybean cash signals were the tightest of the three markets. At the Gulf, CIF Nov barges around +72¢ over Jan and FOB Dec premiums near +107¢ held at historically strong harvest levels, while PNW slots traded roughly 20–30¢/bu richer than the Gulf for some nearby positions. In the interior, crushers and river elevators leaned into the rally: spot bids gained about 5¢ at major plants such as Decatur and Lafayette and 2–3¢ along the Mississippi River as record NOPA October crush and fresh Chinese business encouraged end-users to extend coverage. With weekly inspections near 1.18 MMT and season-to-date volumes about 42 percent below last year's slow start, the basis picture is fully consistent with the narrowing Jan/Mar spread and a market where physical demand is tighter than the paper carryout alone suggests.

Wheat: Wheat basis remained softer than corn and soy but still respectable given the heavier WASDE stocks. Export inspections of 246,533 mt kept marketing-year shipments roughly 19 percent ahead of last

season, and Gulf/PNW FOB indications for SRW, HRW and soft white moved only modestly week-on-week despite Russian 12.5 percent FOB values stuck in the low-\$230s/mt. Gulf SRW stayed discounted to HRW/HRS, but there was no sign of panic discounting after the report. Interior basis in the Southern Plains milling market remains defensive, reflecting carry incentives and comfortable supplies, but has not weakened enough to contradict USDA's 900 mbu export projection. Overall, wheat cash markets are behaving like a classic carry environment: exporters and mills are willing to validate current board levels, but rallies into the high-\$5s are still expected to draw hedge selling rather than chase nearby supply.

International Cash & Trade Flows

Brazil: Brazil continues to assert its dominance as the global supplier of both soybeans and corn. The ANEC now projects soybean exports in November at around 4.71 MMT, up from an earlier 4.26 MMT estimate. Corn export forecasts were also raised to approximately 6.36 MMT. On the pricing front, FOB Santos soybean offers remain strong (near \$480/MT or \$10.92/bu) and continue to hold a premium advantage over US Gulf equivalents into China. Although precise current FOB maize values are less clearly documented in the latest update, previous summaries had Brazil's corn FOB offers around \$210/MT (\$5.30/bu) into Southeast Asia. Interior conditions show planting for the next soybean crop advancing (for example Mato Grosso is past the midway mark), but subsoil moisture deficits are still flagged in parts of Goiás and Tocantins. Export corridors remain functional with no significant congestion reported.

Argentina: Up-River FOB export prices in Argentina are reportedly steady to modestly lower: corn is offered near \$205/MT, and soymeal (47 percent protein) around \$305/MT, both broadly in line with recent levels. Farmer selling continues to slow after the end of the export incentive program, making upstream liquidity less aggressive. The Rosario Exchange reaffirmed its corn planting estimate at about 40 percent of area complete, above average, and reiterated an outlook of near 52 MMT production under neutral/wet summer conditions. The parallel-rate peso exchange (near ARS 1,410/USD) maintains pressure on local exporters and farm selling behavior. Wheat harvest is underway in the north under dry-but-manageable conditions with expectations near 24.5 MMT.

China: Import activity remains heavily Brazil-centric. US Gulf soybean offers (reported near +\$2.20/bu over Jan futures) remain uncompetitive relative to Brazilian cargoes (roughly +\$2.10/bu equivalent), which is contributing to Chinese bookings favoring Brazil. No new confirmed US soybean purchases by Chinese importers have been formally published through Nov 19 beyond the mid-month COFCO activity, and USDA did not report any new flash sales this week. The Nov 10 suspension of Chinese retaliatory tariffs on US corn and wheat (soybeans unchanged at 13 percent MFN duty) is noted but has not yet led to a major shift in Chinese buying patterns. On the domestic front, Dalian Jan corn futures topped ¥2,151/MT (\$6.46/bu equivalent), still well above landed import parity, so commercial crush margins remain constrained. While market commentary around long-term Chinese soybean import targets (12 MMT for 2025, 25+ MMT through 2028) continues to circulate, these remain guidance rather than definitive purchase commitments.

EU / Black Sea: Russian 12.5% protein FOB wheat offers remain around \$232/MT, reflecting export tax adjustments and sustained pricing discipline. Russia continues to win major tenders in Egypt and the Middle East. French wheat offered near \$225/MT remains less competitive, especially as Maghreb and North African tenders favour Black Sea origin. Ukrainian corn continues steady flows via the Danube and rail with inbound FOB offers near ~\$207/MT into Spain/Italy. Within the EU, internal grain availability has improved post-harvest, lessening near-term import urgency. Black Sea soymeal, Russian and Ukrainian

origin, continues to displace U.S. product into southern Europe, aided by favorable freight and FX dynamics.

Other Origins: No major changes reported from Canada or South Africa. Canada's spring wheat exports remain stable, targeting Mexico and East Asia. Australia's harvest expansion across Queensland and New South Wales reveals improved protein but mixed yield outcomes after a dry winter. India remains effectively inactive on the global grain-export stage with no new policy shifts announced.

So What? US exporters continue to face structural headwinds in key Asian and MENA markets as Brazil and Russia maintain pricing leadership. China's continued preference for Brazilian beans, even following tariff adjustments, limits US Gulf traction. While Argentina's political calendar introduces a potential variable, it is not currently shifting the broader flow dynamic. Until FOB spreads narrow or tariff dynamics change materially, US cash and export strength will remain more reliant on domestic demand fundamentals and CIF competitiveness rather than on major export arbitrage gains.

Key Fundamentals & Reports (Nov 13 – Nov 19)

Government Data & Reporting: USDA reporting has fully normalized after earlier delays, *with Export Inspections, Export Sales*, and the November *WASDE* all published on schedule. The return of full data flow removed the uncertainty that shaped trading earlier in the month, particularly in soybeans where Chinese activity had been difficult to confirm. *Crop Progress* was not updated this week given harvest completion, leaving the market to rely on state updates and private surveys for any final fieldwork commentary. *CFTC Commitments of Traders* remain delayed, keeping speculative exposure opaque and pushing traders to lean more heavily on observable physical indicators, spreads, basis, export flow, rather than fund positioning as a directional input

Crop Progress: The late-season fieldwork is essentially finished, with corn 91 percent harvested and soybeans 95 percent complete, both slightly behind the five-year average. Winter wheat planting has reached 92 percent nationwide and emergence stands at 79 percent, each a few points below average, with most Northwestern states fully planted while Nebraska remains notably behind normal. Early HRW ratings show 45 percent of the crop in good-to-excellent condition, down from a year ago, and dryness in western Kansas and Oklahoma continues to be a point of attention as the crop moves toward dormancy.

Export Inspections (USDA FGIS – week ending Oct Nov 13): Corn inspections surged to 2.053 MMT (+38 percent w/w), pushing cumulative 2025/26 shipments to roughly 15.84 MMT, more than 70 percent ahead of last year and now firmly aligned with USDA's higher 2.3 bbu export projection. Soybean loadings improved to 1.176 MMT, maintaining season-to-date shipments near 10.11 MMT, around 42 percent below last year's exceptionally slow start. Wheat inspections totaled 246.5k tonnes (–15 percent w/w), but cumulative exports reached 12.35 MMT, nearly 19 percent ahead of last year and consistent with USDA's unchanged 900 mbu target. The week's flow reaffirmed a strong corn export program, a still-improving soybean pace driven by China, and a wheat program outperforming expectations despite global competition.

Export Sales (USDA FAS, catch-up releases): Delayed weekly sales reports finally caught up this week, delivering clarity after an extended period of backlog and quiet headlines. For soybeans, the data revealed net Chinese purchases of roughly 0.33 MMT offset by 0.10 MMT in cancellations, complemented by a separate USDA daily flash of 0.792 MMT in fresh sales to China, widely linked to state-owned COFCO securing at least 14 cargoes (0.85–0.90 MMT) for December/January shipment.

Corn commitments held steady with strong participation from Mexico and other Western Hemisphere buyers, while wheat bookings proved sufficient to underpin USDA's unchanged export line. The resolution of these delayed figures removed a key source of uncertainty that had constrained trader conviction earlier in November, helping support the firmer tone observed in nearby soybean and corn spreads.

Ethanol Production & Stocks (EIA – week ending Nov 7): Ethanol production held firm through early November, with the latest EIA print showing output at 1.075 mb/d for the week ending Nov. 7, consistent with the strong run rates seen through October (1.071–1.123 mb/d). Margins have softened alongside crude slipping below \$60/bbl, but they remain positive enough to keep Western Corn Belt processor bids well-supported and maintain a steady grind. Stocks edged slightly higher, reflecting normal pre-year-end seasonal patterning rather than a demand slowdown. Overall, industrial use remains stable, reinforcing the firmness seen in nearby corn spreads and cash markets.

NOPA Crush: NOPA reported October crush at 227.65 mbu, the largest monthly crush on record and nearly 14 percent above last year. This confirmed that US processors are running hard into year-end and fully validated USDA's 2.31 bbu 2025/26 crush projection. Strong soymeal demand and historically elevated crush margins continue to anchor domestic soybean usage, offsetting the softer tone in export forecasts.

CFTC Commitments of Traders: No new CFTC reports were released this week, leaving managed-money positioning entirely dependent on private trackers and CME open interest changes. Private estimates suggested only modest net changes: corn lightly net short with limited short-covering, soybeans biased toward modest net length after early-week buying, and wheat remaining heavily net short but with little confirmed movement. Without official data, speculative influence remains secondary to physical flows, basis strength, and the post-WASDE adjustment process.

So What? With USDA reporting fully restored and WASDE adjustments absorbed, market direction this week was driven overwhelmingly by physical movement rather than paper balance sheets. Corn fundamentals strengthened meaningfully on the back of another week of strong inspections and firm basis. Soybeans gained support from confirmed Chinese buying and record crush, easing concerns about the export cut in the WASDE. Wheat continues to carry the heaviest balance sheet but is outperforming expectations thanks to solid export execution and stable FOB values. With CFTC data still absent and South American weather moving into a more sensitive phase, the physical side of the market remains the primary anchor, and this week's physical signals were decisively stronger than the headline supply numbers alone would suggest.

International Reports:

Brazil – ANEC Lineups & Diverging Weather: Mid-November ANEC schedules point to soybean exports near 4.71 MMT for the month to date and corn loadings around 6.3 MMT, consistent with strong second-crop movement but softer relative to historical volumes than October's unusually heavy flow. Brazilian FOB values remain competitive: Santos soybeans traded near \$480/MT (\$10.90/bu), keeping a modest discount to US Gulf offers, while corn around \$210/MT (\$5.30/bu) continues to set the floor for global feed grain markets. Planting progress stayed split north–south: Mato Grosso maintained a near-normal pace while Rio Grande do Sul and Paraná showed patchier emergence due to intermittent dryness, a pattern that keeps some early-season risk premium alive. Central and northern regions received more regular rainfall, supporting replanting decisions and stabilizing forward yield expectations. No new CONAB revisions were released within the window, but private consultants continue to flag a slight downward bias to early soybean yield assumptions if southern rainfall remains inconsistent. Port logistics at Santos and Paranaguá remained fluid, with no reports of congestion.

Argentina – BCBA & MAGyP Updates: The Buenos Aires Grain Exchange reported corn planting advancing steadily under improved soil moisture, while soybean planting gained momentum across core provinces. Wheat harvest progressed in the northern belt, and BCBA raised production expectations to 24.5 MMT, broadly aligned with early-November assessments. Up-River FOB offers held steady, with corn quoted near \$205/MT and soymeal around \$305/MT, reflecting stable export competitiveness. MAGyP's weekly updates showed no major surprises in sowing progress or crop conditions. The peso continued to weaken in parallel markets, sustaining strong export incentives, while farmer selling remained cautious ahead of ongoing political and macro uncertainty. Crushers continued to draw on inventories accumulated under September's "soy dollar 5" program, keeping meal and oil flows steady.

China – Import Behavior & Post-Tariff Dynamics: China's import behavior this week centered on confirmation of reserve-oriented US soybean buying, rather than commercial crush demand. Reuters reported COFCO securing 14 US cargoes (0.85–0.90 MMT) for Dec/Jan shipment, and USDA daily data confirmed 0.792 MMT of fresh sales to China. Despite this pickup, crushers remained focused on Brazilian offers for January–March arrival windows, and domestic margins stayed under pressure from high port inventories and weak soymeal demand. Chinese futures markets were broadly steady: Dalian corn hovered near ¥2,150/MT, soybeans around ¥4,970/MT, and soymeal near ¥3,040/MT, signaling muted domestic pull. No new announcements were made by MARA or Customs, and while China's earlier tariff adjustments on US grains reshaped sentiment, soybean duties remain effectively unchanged for commercial buyers. Market chatter continued around whether state purchases dilute the tariff constraint, but operationally there was still no shift in crushers' import behavior.

Black Sea / EU – Russia Maintains Competitive Edge: Black Sea origins maintained their grip on global pricing and tender activity this week. Russian 12.5% protein wheat FOB offers stayed firm in the \$232–233/MT range, continuing to set the floor for milling wheat values worldwide and capturing the lion's share of Egyptian and Middle Eastern tenders. Russia's export tempo held strong, with early-November volumes tracking comfortably above last year's levels. Ukrainian corn flows via Danube and Black Sea ports remained competitively priced near \$207/MT, keeping downward pressure on EU feed grain values. In Europe, winter wheat establishment progressed solidly across key areas, with FranceAgriMer reporting conditions steady in the mid-to-upper 60s percent good-to-excellent. EU internal supply feels comfortable, reflected in Rouen offers around \$225/MT with little upward tension. No meaningful logistical issues were noted along Black Sea or Danube routes during the period.

Global – Multilateral Updates: No major new multilateral updates were released within the window, leaving IGC's late-October numbers as the reference point. Global trade sentiment remained balanced: comfortable inventories for wheat and corn, record US crush supporting soy product markets, and early-season risk resting primarily in southern Brazil's rainfall profile rather than geopolitical shocks. Freight, container availability, and shipping routes remained stable, keeping global arbitrage dominated by export competition rather than supply scarcity.

So What? Global grain flows continue to be shaped by Brazil's dominance in corn, state-led Chinese soybean demand, and ultra-competitive Russian wheat pricing. Argentina remains competitively positioned but macro-risk sensitive, while Chinese importer's buying pattern reinforced that US soy strength is being driven by reserves, not commercial crush margins. With no major multilateral revisions and logistics functioning smoothly, international markets continue to price off competitive origins rather than tightness. The next meaningful drivers will be Brazil's late-November rainfall distribution and whether China converts this week's reserve buying into sustained forward demand, both of which will influence nearby US spreads and basis as we move toward December.

Weather & Crop Conditions

United States

Crop Progress & Rainfall: US harvest is now essentially wrapped up, with corn 91 percent complete and soybeans 95 percent harvested, leaving only light activity in pockets of the Upper Midwest and far northern areas. Early-week precipitation across the Ohio Valley and Mid-South improved surface moisture and aided barge drafts along the lower Mississippi, helping normalize flow after recent low-water constraints. In the Plains, winter wheat establishment is progressing but remains uneven: planting has reached 92 percent and emergence stands at 79 percent, both slightly behind average, while persistent topsoil dryness across western Kansas and Oklahoma continues to limit early HRW condition gains despite scattered 10–20 mm showers.

River Levels & Logistics: Mississippi River conditions continued to stabilize, with gauge readings at Memphis, St. Louis and Baton Rouge improving modestly on the back of early-November rainfall. Standard barge drafts remained in effect through most of the week, keeping freight steady to slightly firmer depending on loading window and segment. Logistics along the Lower Miss and Ohio Rivers were described as “functional but still sensitive,” with carriers noting that water levels remain below historical averages, maintaining a cautious tone for the next 2–3 weeks of holiday-season traffic. Improved flow supported steady CIF basis levels and helped clear the large export inspection volumes reported this week.

Temperatures: Conditions stayed seasonally mild across much of the Midwest and Plains, with highs in the 50s–60s°F and above-normal warmth persisting into the weekend. The mild pattern aided final fieldwork and natural dry-down while slowing soil moisture recharge across the HRW belt. No frost events or quality concerns were reported, and the absence of severe cold continues to support winter wheat establishment in the central and northern Plains.

Outlook (6–10 days): NOAA's mid-November outlook points to above-normal temperatures across the central US and continued dryness for Kansas, Nebraska and western Oklahoma. Improved rainfall chances are focused on the Ohio Valley and Lower Mississippi basin, providing potential incremental relief for barge logistics. For wheat areas, however, the forecast remains marginal, with limited precipitation expected to address deeper topsoil deficits across the southwestern Plains.

South America:

Brazil: Weather remained sharply divided between north–central Brazil and the southern belt. Regular showers returned across Mato Grosso, Goiás and Tocantins, delivering 20–50 mm in several producing areas and allowing soybean planting to recover momentum after early-season delays. Planting progress in the Central-West moved closer to normal historical pace, and replanting where necessary has proceeded smoothly. Subsoil moisture, however, remains below average across pockets of Goiás and northeastern Mato Grosso, keeping agronomic risks elevated until more consistent rainfall arrives. In contrast, southern states (Rio Grande do Sul and Paraná) continued to face patchier rainfall and uneven emergence, a theme closely watched by the trade given its potential influence on early yield expectations and safrinha planting windows. Forecasts from INMET and NOAA call for additional rainfall in the Central-West but limited relief for the southern belt over the next 7–10 days.

Argentina: Conditions remained broadly favorable. BCBA maintained adequate-to-optimal soil moisture ratings across most Pampas provinces, with only isolated dryness in southwestern Córdoba. Early corn and newly sown soybeans continue to establish well, supported by stable temperatures and periodic thunderstorms delivering about an inch (20–35 mm) of rainfall across central and northern regions. Wheat harvest advanced in northern provinces under benign conditions, and quality concerns remain limited.

Near-term forecasts continue to point toward intermittent showers and moderate temperatures, sustaining an overall constructive outlook.

Global: Winter wheat development across the Northern Hemisphere continued on a generally steady track. In Russia and Ukraine, mild temperatures combined with adequate moisture supported solid emergence and early tillering stages. European conditions remained stable, with sufficient rainfall reported in France, Germany, and Poland; FranceAgriMer maintained ratings for French soft wheat in the upper 60s percent good-to-excellent. Down under, Australia's crop showed its typical regional divide: persistent dryness in Western Australia capped yield potential, whereas scattered showers in New South Wales and Queensland helped preserve harvest quality without dramatically altering overall output. Elsewhere, including India, South Africa, and Canada, no notable disruptions emerged during the period.

So What? With U.S. harvest now in the final stages (corn 91 percent complete, soybeans 95 percent), weather has largely faded as a domestic price driver, giving way to logistics and export execution as the key influences. Better barge movement along the river system has bolstered CIF basis levels and facilitated the clearance of robust corn and soybean inspection volumes. On the global front, Brazil continues to dominate the weather watch: steady rains have firmed up prospects in the Central-West, but patchy distribution in the south keeps a modest risk premium intact for soybeans, and by extension, early safrinha corn. Argentina's favorable pattern and rapid planting progress provide a counterbalance to regional concerns, while the Black Sea region and EU enjoy solid early conditions for winter wheat. Markets stay highly attuned to southern Brazil's rainfall outlook through late November, as any persistent dryness could translate into stronger, longer-lasting support for U.S. nearby basis and spreads.

Synthesis & Outlook

The post-WASDE week delivered the first full reset of market narratives since early September, as traders moved from speculation to confirmation and the physical market continued to set the tone. The November WASDE was undeniably heavier on paper for corn and wheat, and only modestly tighter for soybeans, yet the market's response was far more nuanced than Friday's initial break suggested. By Monday, futures in all three markets had stabilized or reversed: December corn recovered back toward \$4.35/bu, January soybeans pushed into the mid-\$11.50s, and December SRW wheat reclaimed the mid-\$5.40s. Spreads tightened rather than loosened, with corn Dec/Mar firming toward 58% of full carry, soybeans Jan/Mar tightening sharply to 31%, and wheat Dec/Mar holding near 56%. The consistency in spread strength underscored the same message visible across inspections, basis and crush margins: the physical pipeline is still doing more work than the futures curve would imply.

Speculative participation remained thin, with no clean CFTC read available and traders forced to rely on price behavior, open interest, and options flow instead. The pattern resembled position cleanup rather than conviction: funds leaned into the Friday break but did not extend it, and early-week strength looked more like short-covering than new longs in either corn or wheat. Soybeans showed the clearest discretionary buying interest, with the combination of record crush, strong basis and confirmed Chinese purchases giving the board enough support to shake off the WASDE's export cut. Overall, the market continues to trade a commercial-led structure, with spreads, basis grids and export execution guiding sentiment more than macro inputs or fund flows.

Globally, Brazil and Russia continued to anchor price discovery. Brazil's export machine remained dominant, with corn still setting the global feed benchmark and soybeans maintaining a discount to US Gulf offers. Rainfall improved across Mato Grosso, Goiás and Tocantins, stabilizing planting momentum, while southern Brazil stayed drier and preserved a mild risk premium into the end of November. Argentina's conditions remained constructive, with early corn and soybeans establishing well and wheat harvest progressing without major setbacks. Russia held its grip on global wheat pricing, with 12.5